

JHU - Krieger School of Arts & Sciences / Whiting School of Engineering

ASEN.2026.Spring Project 2

Course: EN.553.433.01.SP26: Monte Carlo Methods

Instructor: Apurva Nakade *

Response Rate: 16/16 (100.00 %)

1 - The overall quality of this course is:

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means								
Poor		(1)	0	0.00%		4.56								
Weak		(2)	0	0.00%										
Satisfactory		(3)	2	12.50%										
Good		(4)	3	18.75%										
Excellent		(5)	11	68.75%										
N/A		(0)	0	0.00%										
					02550100	Question		School Level		Department Level				
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
16/16 (100.00%)		4.56	0.73	5.00	11087		4.24	0.92	4.00	11087		4.24	0.92	4.00

2 - The instructor's teaching effectiveness is:

Apurva Nakade

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%			4.69	4.31	4.31			
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%								
Satisfactory				(3)	0	0.00%								
Good				(4)	5	31.25%								
Excellent				(5)	11	68.75%								
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%								
02550100								Question	School Level	Department Level				
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
16/16 (100.00%)		4.69	0.48	5.00	11933		4.31	0.92	5.00	11933		4.31	0.92	5.00

3 - The intellectual challenge of this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%								
Weak				(2)	1	6.25%								
Satisfactory				(3)	2	12.50%								
Good				(4)	5	31.25%								
Excellent				(5)	8	50.00%								
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%								
02550100								Question	School Level	Department Level				
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
16/16 (100.00%)		4.25	0.93	4.50	10800		4.28	0.83	4.00	10800		4.28	0.83	4.00

4 - The teaching assistant for this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%								
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%								
Satisfactory				(3)	5	35.71%								
Good				(4)	3	21.43%								
Excellent				(5)	3	21.43%								
N/A				(0)	3	21.43%								
02550100							Question		School Level		Department Level			
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
14/16 (87.50%)		3.82	0.87	4.00	10671		4.31	0.90	5.00	10671		4.31	0.90	5.00

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Course: EN.553.433.01.SP26: Monte Carlo Methods

Instructor: Apurva Nakade *

Response Rate: 16/16 (100.00 %)

5 - Please enter the name of the TA you evaluated in question 4:

Response Rate 2/16 (12.5%)

- Jingyi Zhang
- Qiuxin Gao, Jingyi Zhang

6 - Feedback on my work for this course is useful:

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means										
Disagree strongly		(1)	0	0.00%												
Disagree somewhat		(2)	1	6.25%												
Neither agree nor disagree		(3)	2	12.50%												
Agree somewhat		(4)	10	62.50%												
Agree strongly		(5)	2	12.50%												
N/A		(0)	1	6.25%												
					0	25	50	100	Question		School Level		Department Level			
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median		
16/16 (100.00%)		3.87	0.74	4.00	10551		4.17	0.97	4.00	10551		4.17	0.97	4.00		

7 - Compared to other Hopkins courses at this level, the workload for this course is:

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means								
Much lighter		(1)	0	0.00%										
Somewhat lighter		(2)	6	37.50%										
Typical		(3)	7	43.75%										
Somewhat heavier		(4)	3	18.75%										
Much heavier		(5)	0	0.00%										
N/A		(0)	0	0.00%										
					0	25	50	100	Question	School Level	Department Level			
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
16/16 (100.00%)		2.81	0.75	3.00	10580		3.31	0.91	3.00	10580		3.31	0.91	3.00

8 - What are the best aspects of this course?

Response Rate 5/16 (31.25%)

- The course is taught very well and the course design is very good where you are learning something and then immediately being quizzed on it which really makes sure that you understand the content you are learning.
- The content is interesting and Dr. Nakade is great. The weekly quizzes are the perfect challenge level to keep you up to date without much stress.
- Good lecture style, very relevant / useful knowledge to learn for applied mathematicians / computer scientists.
- Has some interesting topics, Apurva teaches very clearly even if it is a bit slow
- Monte Carlo methods are everywhere, so it's a useful subject to know. Apurva is a good professor, and it has a quiz structure instead of an exam structure.

9 - What are the worst aspects of this course?

Response Rate 4/16 (25%)

- The grading is very minimal and you really just get your scores back and not a ton of feedback.
- Project selection is somewhat tough.
- The course moves very slow and is taught at a very basic level for a 400 level course. The first 2 weeks did not have much new material beyond Probability (a pre-req). In general, the professor should have assumed a higher level of knowledge from the probability course here (no need to explain what a Bivariate normal is). For newer topics like SDEs or continuous Markov processes, while we discussed some of the theory at a high level, we could have gone much more in depth with more rigor
- Final project: I still would've preferred an exam or an individual project without a presentation component.

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Response Rate: 16/16 (100.00 %)

10 - What would most improve this class?

Response Rate 4/16 (25%)

- More feedback on HW/quizzes
- Having some time for review during section would be nice because we have 50 minutes but use up to 30. It could be at the end and optional.
- If the course instruction moved at a faster pace and assumed a higher level of mathematical maturity that would be ideal. It is a 400 level applied math course after all
- The class has lecture notes provided: updating them with all the content would be helpful. Also! More practice problems (this helped a lot with the probability class).

11 - What should prospective students know about this course before enrolling? (You may comment on any aspect of this course such as assumed background, readings, grading systems, and so on.)

Response Rate 4/16 (25%)

- Just show up to class and go to office hours if you don't understand something because otherwise the quizzes will be very hard.
- It is a good course, highly recommend!
- May be good to take some prob class before taking this one
- Be familiar with probability!

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ASEN.2026.Spring Project 2

Course: EN.553.633.01.SP26: Monte Carlo Methods
Instructor: Apurva Nakade *
Response Rate: 13/13 (100.00 %)

1 - The overall quality of this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means					
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%							
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%							
Satisfactory				(3)	0	0.00%							
Good				(4)	3	23.08%							
Excellent				(5)	10	76.92%							
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%							
							02550100	Question	School Level	Department Level			
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level	Mean	STD	Median
13/13 (100.00%)		4.77	0.44	5.00	11087		4.24	0.92	4.00	11087	4.24	0.92	4.00

2 - The instructor's teaching effectiveness is:

Apurva Nakade

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%								
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%								
Satisfactory				(3)	0	0.00%								
Good				(4)	2	15.38%								
Excellent				(5)	11	84.62%								
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%								
							02550100	Question	School Level	Department Level				
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
13/13 (100.00%)		4.85	0.38	5.00	11933		4.31	0.92	5.00	11933		4.31	0.92	5.00

3 - The intellectual challenge of this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%								
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%								
Satisfactory				(3)	0	0.00%								
Good				(4)	3	23.08%								
Excellent				(5)	10	76.92%								
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%								
0 25 50 100							Question	School Level	Department Level					
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
13/13 (100.00%)		4.77	0.44	5.00	10800		4.28	0.83	4.00	10800		4.28	0.83	4.00

4 - The teaching assistant for this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor				(1)	1	8.33%								
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%								
Satisfactory				(3)	0	0.00%								
Good				(4)	3	25.00%								
Excellent				(5)	7	58.33%								
N/A				(0)	1	8.33%								
							02550100	Question	School Level	Department Level				
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
12/13 (92.31%)		4.36	1.21	5.00	10671		4.31	0.90	5.00	10671		4.31	0.90	5.00

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Response Rate: 13/13 (100.00 %)

5 - Please enter the name of the TA you evaluated in question 4:

Response Rate 4/13 (30.77%)

- NA
- Jingyi Zhang
- Jingyi Zhang
- Qiuxin Gao

6 - Feedback on my work for this course is useful:

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means								
Disagree strongly		(1)	0	0.00%		4.67 4.17 4.17								
Disagree somewhat		(2)	0	0.00%										
Neither agree nor disagree		(3)	0	0.00%										
Agree somewhat		(4)	4	30.77%										
Agree strongly		(5)	8	61.54%										
N/A		(0)	1	7.69%										
					02550100	Question		School Level		Department Level				
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median
13/13 (100.00%)		4.67	0.49	5.00	10551		4.17	0.97	4.00	10551		4.17	0.97	4.00

7 - Compared to other Hopkins courses at this level, the workload for this course is:

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means										
Much lighter		(1)	1	7.69%												
Somewhat lighter		(2)	0	0.00%												
Typical		(3)	8	61.54%												
Somewhat heavier		(4)	3	23.08%												
Much heavier		(5)	0	0.00%												
N/A		(0)	1	7.69%												
					0	25	50	100	Question		School Level		Department Level			
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School Level		Mean	STD	Median	Department Level		Mean	STD	Median		
13/13 (100.00%)		3.08	0.79	3.00	10580		3.31	0.91	3.00	10580		3.31	0.91	3.00		

8 - What are the best aspects of this course?

Response Rate 3/13 (23.08%)

- final project
- That I get to incorporate with my team and enhance my understanding and prepare for future career.
- Lectures are interesting and engaging. The focus on quizzes works.

9 - What are the worst aspects of this course?

Response Rate 3/13 (23.08%)

- none
- n/a
- Quiz difficulty fluctuated making them harder to prepare for.

10 - What would most improve this class?

Response Rate 3/13 (23.08%)

- none
- n/a
- It's a hard task but figuring out some way for all quizzes to be about equal difficulty.

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Response Rate: 13/13 (100.00 %)

11 - What should prospective students know about this course before enrolling? (You may comment on any aspect of this course such as assumed background, readings, grading systems, and so on.)

Response Rate	2/13 (15.38%)
• nonr • n/a	